PEST analysis for your business

SAY: “Today you will use PEST to explain how outside changes affect a business you choose.”

DO: Print both pages double-sided, flipping on the long edge. Distribute the sheet and identify the target.

CHECK: Students know that PEST concerns external influences, not the four Ps.

30 minutes

Activity sequence

SAY: “We will complete one PEST section at a time. I will tell you when to move.”

DO: Keep the introduction within five minutes, including the short model.

NOTE: 3–5 + 2 + 12 + 5 =22–24, leaving 6–8 minutes. If discussion runs longer, reduce buffer rather than claiming work finished.

A 30-minute planning window

Proficiency and deeper reasoning

3 Proficient
Accurate PEST categories, relevant examples, + and – impacts explained in complete thoughts, and a clear business response.

4 Exceeds
Meets level 3 and independently explains a justified priority, trade-off, or connection between factors.

Announce numerical levels only after Pat approves them.

Teacher-only proposal: confirm with Pat

Developing understanding

2 Developing
Some relevant ideas, but impacts or business connections are incomplete or unclear.

1 Initial
Limited relevant evidence so far; substantial support needed to explain the effects.

Use your textbook and notes. Ask for clarification.

Announce numerical levels only after Pat approves them.

Teacher-only proposal: confirm with Pat

Political influence

SAY: “The same external change can create an opportunity and a cost. Your example must explain why.”

DO: Model only this one factor, then let students apply the other categories.

RESPONSE: The shop could train staff and plan for compliance costs. This is an internal response to an external factor.

Second reveal: negative impact

Business and target market

SAY: “Choose a business you understand and name its target market. Who buys from it, and what do they want?”

DO: Start a 2-minute timer. If stuck, offer a familiar business category such as a cafe, shoe shop, or digital-book service.

CHECK: Both names, business, and target market recorded.
SAY: “Use the back (page 2) for longer answers. Label P, E, S, or T.”

2 minutes

P Political

SAY: “What outside rule or policy could affect this business? Give a connected example and explain both possible impacts.”

DO: Start a 3-minute timer. Each partner explains an impact. Record the shared answer and switch roles for the next category.

LOOK FOR: External factor, correct category, business impact, and a because explanation.

SUPPORT: Ask what changed outside the business and what happens to costs, customers, or access.

EXTEND: Ask which impact matters most and why.

CHECK: An ad, discount, or app chosen by the business is its internal response, not the external factor.

3 minutes

E Economic

SAY: “What outside economic change could affect costs or demand? Give a connected example and explain both possible impacts.”

DO: Start a 3-minute timer. Each partner explains an impact. Record the shared answer and switch roles for the next category.

LOOK FOR: External factor, correct category, business impact, and a because explanation.

SUPPORT: Ask what changed outside the business and what happens to costs, customers, or access.

EXTEND: Ask which impact matters most and why.

CHECK: An ad, discount, or app chosen by the business is its internal response, not the external factor.

3 minutes

S Social

SAY: “What change in the customers or community could affect demand? Give a connected example and explain both possible impacts.”

DO: Start a 3-minute timer. Each partner explains an impact. Record the shared answer and switch roles for the next category.

LOOK FOR: External factor, correct category, business impact, and a because explanation.

SUPPORT: Ask what changed outside the business and what happens to costs, customers, or access.

EXTEND: Ask which impact matters most and why.

CHECK: An ad, discount, or app chosen by the business is its internal response, not the external factor.

3 minutes

T Technological

SAY: “What outside technology change could affect access, service, or competition? Give a connected example and explain both possible impacts.”

DO: Start a 3-minute timer. Each partner explains an impact. Record the shared answer and switch roles for the next category.

LOOK FOR: External factor, correct category, business impact, and a because explanation.

SUPPORT: Ask what changed outside the business and what happens to costs, customers, or access.

EXTEND: Ask which impact matters most and why.

CHECK: An ad, discount, or app chosen by the business is its internal response, not the external factor.

3 minutes

Business summary

SAY: “Connect the analysis to a business decision. Which opportunity would you use? Which risk would you address? Why?”

DO: Direct students to the back (page 2). Invite 2–4 complete sentences as a guide, not a scored word count. Students may orally rehearse first.

CHECK: Responses follow from their own factors, not generic advice.

EXTEND: Compare priorities or two interacting factors and justify a trade-off.

PAIR CHECK: Both partners can explain the agreed business response.

5 minutes

Completion check and Terms to Know

SAY: “Check each section. Circle a place where you explained why. Use remaining time to practise the approved Terms to Know.”

DO: Check both sides of the sheet. Record separate Block 1 and Block 5 stops.

OPEN: Confirm quiz scope, collection route, how pair evidence will be assessed, and grading with Pat. Do not invent a deadline.

RECORD: Block 1 stop/support needed __ ; Block 5 stop/support needed __.

Remaining 6–8 minutes